

TRACERY

Tracery is the decorative stone molding found in vaulting, panels, and especially windows. It originated with the pointed Gothic arch window; this usually held two vertical, pointed windows within a single frame, leaving space below the peak of the main arch. This space was often carved with a decorative window, a technique known as plate tracery, after the carved "plate" of stone.

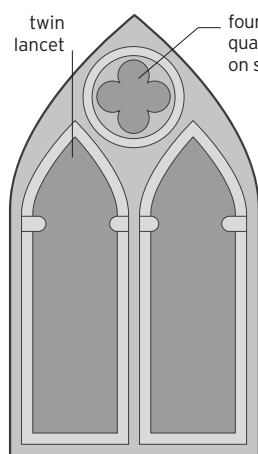
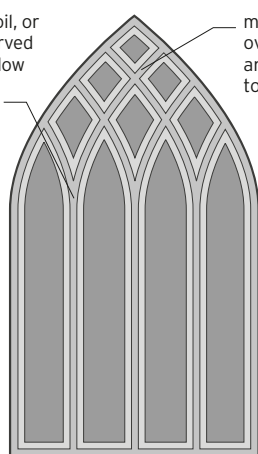
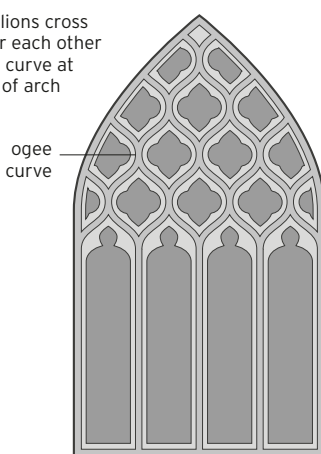


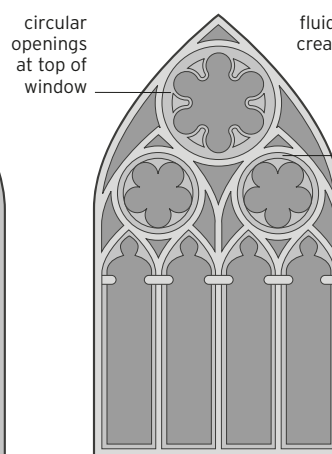
PLATE TRACERY



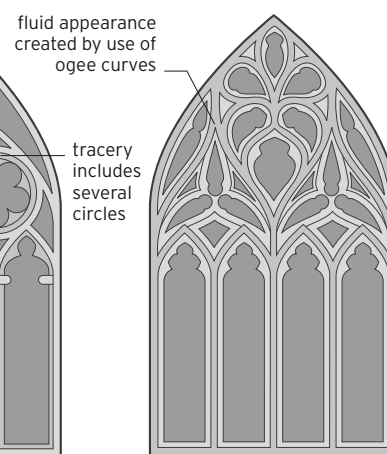
INTERSECTING TRACERY



RETICULATED TRACERY



GEOMETRICAL TRACERY

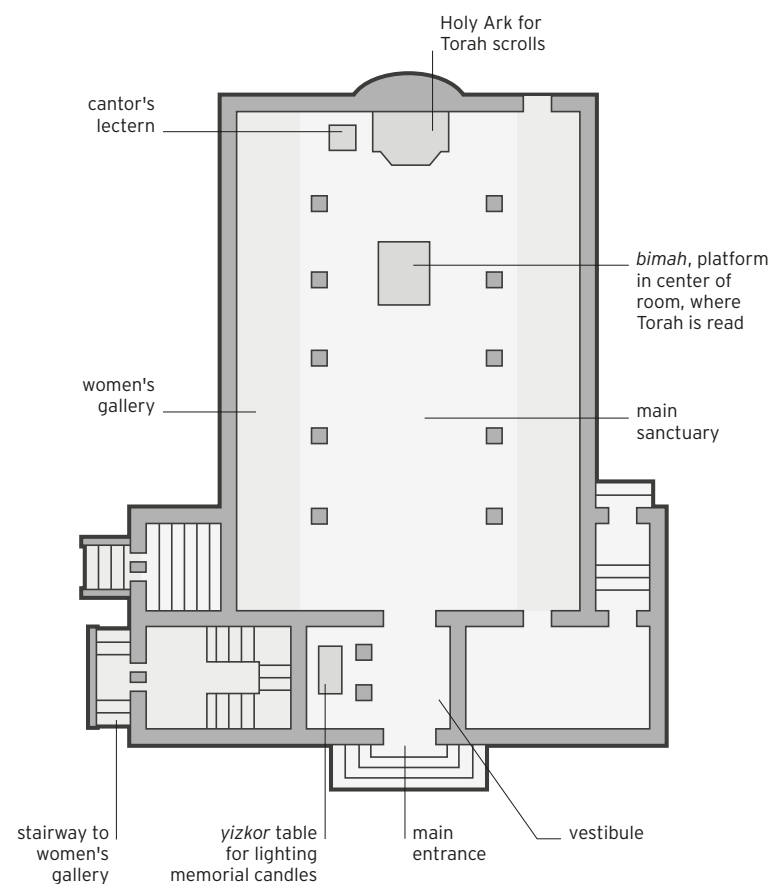


CURVILINEAR TRACERY

This gave way to bar tracery, in which panes of glass were separated by thin mullions of stone. Tracery developed into complex patterns, such as intersecting (mullions curve to the arch head), reticulated (circles forming ogee patterns), and curvilinear (based on ogee curves) forms.

SYNAGOGUE

As with churches and mosques, there are no set requirements for synagogues. They vary greatly in form according to when and where they are built. According to Jewish tradition, worship is possible wherever there is a *minyan*, a quorum of 10 worshippers. However, a traditional synagogue always contains an ark in which the Torah scrolls are kept.



SUBSTRUCTURE The elements below ground, such as foundations and basements, that support a structure above.

SUPERSTRUCTURE The part of a structure that is above ground.

SYNAGOGUE See panel, left.

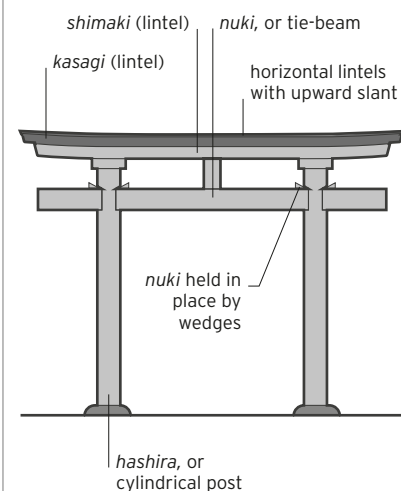
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TALUD-TABLERO A stylistic feature of pyramid construction in Pre-Columbian Mesoamerica that alternates sloping surfaces (talud) with vertical surfaces (tablero).

TALUS A sloping face at the base of a fortified wall in a castle. It was designed to prevent siege towers (portable high towers that allowed attackers to shoot arrows into the fortification) from approaching the base of the wall and to present an obstacle to attackers using scaling ladders.

TESSERA An individual tile used in creating a mosaic. *See also* mosaic.

THOLOS An ancient Greek round temple with a ring of columns supporting a conical roof.



TORII ▲ A gateway at the entrance to the precincts of a Japanese Shinto shrine. It typically consists of two cylindrical posts topped by a horizontal rectangular tie-beam and lintels that extend beyond the posts on either side, with a second horizontal beam below the first. *See also* lintel.

TRACERY See panel, above.